

# Classification of Vitiligo

Vitiligo is classified based on distribution and pattern of involvement into segmental, acrofacial, generalized (vitiligo vulgaris), universal, and mucosal types. Alternatively, it can be categorized by pattern as focal, mixed, or mucosal.

- **Focal vitiligo:** Typically presents as a solitary macule or a few scattered macules confined to one area. It most commonly occurs in the distribution of the trigeminal nerve, though the neck and trunk may also be involved.
- **Segmental vitiligo:** Characterized by unilateral, well-demarcated macules following a dermatomal or quasi-dermatomal pattern. This form often presents at an early age, is more common in children, and is not typically associated with autoimmune thyroid disease or other autoimmune conditions. Neural mechanisms, including altered neural peptides, are thought to play a role in its pathogenesis. Over half of patients develop **poliosis**—white hair within the affected area.
- **Acrofacial vitiligo:** Involves depigmentation of the distal fingers and periorificial regions (around the mouth, eyes, nose, and other orifices).
- **Generalized vitiligo (vitiligo vulgaris):** The most common type, characterized by widespread, usually symmetrical depigmented patches across the body.
- **Universal vitiligo:** Near-complete or complete loss of pigmentation over most of the body surface, often associated with **multiple endocrinopathy syndrome**.
- **Mucosal vitiligo:** Limited to mucous membranes only, without skin involvement.

## Clinical Features

Lesions in vitiligo are typically **well-demarcated**, though margins may appear **scalloped**. They become more apparent under **Wood's lamp examination**.

Lesions enlarge **centrifugally** at variable rates and can develop on any skin or mucosal surface. Initial lesions most frequently appear on the **hands, forearms, feet, and face**. Facial vitiligo often shows a **perioral and periocular** predilection.

## Koebner Phenomenon

**Koebnerization** is common in vitiligo, with new lesions developing at sites of cutaneous trauma—such as friction from clothing, cuts, burns, or abrasions.

## Clinical Variants

- **Trichrome vitiligo:** Features three distinct zones—fully depigmented white skin, partially pigmented (hypopigmented) skin, and normally pigmented skin. The hypopigmented areas often progress to complete depigmentation over time.
- **Quadrichrome vitiligo:** An extension of trichrome vitiligo, with the addition of a fourth color—**hyperpigmented macules**—within or around the lesion.